

Data Annotation Project Guide

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1 Overview

The focus of this project is analyze the cross-linguistic meanings and distributions of a family of grammatical forms that have often been called “perfects”. In English, these are expressed using auxiliary *have* plus a participle, though different languages use many different strategies for conveying these meanings. For the purposes of this project, I am referring to these grammatical forms as “perfect-like grams” (PLGs), where a *gram* is some grammatical element (such as an affix, particle, etc.) that conveys a recurrent meaning in a language, and *perfect-like* refers to grams that have similar meanings to the English Perfect.

The role of annotation in this project is to identify which grams are used in different languages to convey these sorts of meanings. In (1) is an example of some PLGs.

- (1) a. English: I **have visited** Paris three times.
b. Pari o san-kai otozure-ta-koto-ga-aru (Japanese)
Paris dir.obj three-times **visit-past-nmlzr-ptcl-cop**
‘I have visited Paris three times.’
c. ich war dreimal in Paris (German)
I **be.prat** three.times in Paris
‘I have visited Paris three times.’
d. wǒ qù guò bālí sān-cì (Mandarin)
I go **ptcl** Paris three-times
‘I have visited Paris three times.’

In these examples, each language uses a different type of gram to convey (approximately) the same meaning. In (1a), English uses auxiliary *have* and a participle; in (1b), Japanese uses a complex gram that incorporates the past tense marker *-ta*, the nominalizer *koto*, the subject particle *ga*, and the inanimate copula *aru*; in (1c), German uses the verb meaning ‘to be’ in the Präteritum tense; and in (1d), Mandarin uses the aspectual particle *guò* (sometimes called an ‘experiential marker’).

Your primary task will be to read over text in a given language and identify how a target phrase in English is expressed in another language. (You will be provided with the target English phrase to look for.) In addition, where relevant, we ask that you also make note of certain discrepancies between the two corresponding texts; this will be covered in more detail below.

2 Guidelines

The gist of the annotation is relatively straightforward, but I'll include a few references and reminders here in order to make things clear and simple. You are also welcome to email me anytime if you have questions.

2.1 Structure of the Data

To begin, open up the annotation spreadsheet and navigate to the tab for the language you are annotating. (I also made a short version of the link: <https://tinyurl.com/plg-annotation>.) There you'll see alternating lines of text like this:

Done	TokenID	Lang	Target	Text	Gram	Metadata
☐	40001018	ENG	had been promised	The birth genesis : origin beginning of Jesus Christ was as follows : His mother Mary had been promised to Joseph in marriage . But before they were married , Mary realized that she was pregnant by Holy Spirit .		
☐	40001018	JPN		イエス・キリストの誕生の次第はこうであった。母マリヤはヨセフと婚約していたが、まだ一體にならない前に、聖霊によって身重になった。		
☐	40001024	ENG	had commanded	When Joseph woke up , he did what the angel of God had commanded him to do . He took Mary to be his wife .		
☐	40001024	JPN		ヨセフは起りからさめた後に、主の使が命じたとおりに、マリヤを妻に迎えた。		
☐	40003002	ENG	has come near	« Repent , for the kingdom of heaven has come near . »		
☐	40003002	JPN		「悔い改めよ、天国は近づいた。」		
☐	40003017	ENG	have approved	Then a voice from heaven said : « This is my Son whom I love and whom I have approved . »		
☐	40003017	JPN		また天から声があつて言った、「これはわたしの愛する子、わたしの心になう者である。」		
☐	40004012	ENG	had been arrested	Jesus heard that John had been arrested . So Jesus withdrew to Galilee .		
☐	40004012	JPN		さて、イエスはヨハネが捕えられたと聞いて、ガリラヤへ退かれた。		
☐	40005027	ENG	have heard	« You have heard it was said , « You should not commit adultery . »		
☐	40005027	JPN		「禁ずるを」と言われていたことは、あなたがたの聞いていところである。		
☐	40005038	ENG	have heard	« You have heard it said , an eye for an eye and a tooth for a tooth .		
☐	40005038	JPN		「目に目を、歯には歯を」と言われていたことは、あなたがたの聞いていところである。		
☐	40005043	ENG	have heard	« You have heard it said , « You should love your neighbor and hate your enemy . »		
☐	40005043	JPN		「隣人を愛し、敵を憎め」と言われていたことは、あなたがたの聞いていところである。		
☐	40006002	ENG	have been paid	« Do not loudly announce it when you give to the poor . The hypocrites do this in the houses of worship and on the streets . They do this to be praised by men . Believe me , they have already been paid in full .		
☐	40006002	JPN		だから、施しをする時には、偽善者たちが人にほめられるため会堂や町の中でするように、自分の前でラッパを吹きならすな。よく言っておくが、彼らはその報いを受けてしまっている。		
☐	40006005	ENG	have been paid	« Do not pray like the hypocrites ! They want everyone to see them in the houses of worship and on the street corners . I assure you they have been paid in full .		
☐	40006005	JPN		また祈る時には、偽善者たちのようにするな。彼らは人に見せようとして、会堂や大通りのつじに立って祈ることを好む。よく言っておくが、彼らはその報いを受けてしまっている。		
☐	40006016	ENG	have received	« When you abstain from food , do not be like the hypocrites , with sad faces to be seen by men . They have received their reward .		
☐	40006016	JPN		また断食をする時には、偽善者がするように、陰気な顔つきをするな。彼らは断食をしていることを人に見せようとして、自分の顔を見苦しくするのである。よく言っておくが、彼らはその報いを受けてしまっている。		
☐	40007028	ENG	had finished	When Jesus had finished these words , the crowds were astonished at what he taught .		
☐	40007028	JPN		イエスがこれらの言を終えられると、群衆はその教にひどく驚いた。		
☐	40008010	ENG	have not found	When Jesus heard it , he was amazed , and said to the crowd : « I tell you , I have not found such great faith in Israel .		
☐	40008010	JPN		イエスはこれ聞いて非常に感心され、ついてきた人々に言われた、「よく聞きなさい。イスラエル人の中にも、これほどの信仰を見たことがない。		
☐	40008029	ENG	have you come	They screamed at him , saying : « What have we to do with you , Son of God ? Have you come to torment us before the time ? »		
☐	40008029	JPN		すると突然、彼らは叫んで言った、「神の子よ、あなたはわたしどもとんの係わりがあるのです。まだその時ではないのに、ここにきて、わたしどもを苦しめるのですか。」		

The columns are as follows:

- **Done:** This column has checkboxes that you can use (if you like) to filter for just the tokens that are left to be done; to do so, click on the filter icon next to "Done" and de-select "TRUE".
- **TokenID:** This is a unique ID assigned to each token ("token" here refers to each instance of a PLG in the data, one row = one token). Note that sometimes you will encounter multiple tokens that have the same text; in these cases there are multiple PLGs in the same verse, so the Target (see below) will specify which specific element to look evaluate in that row.
- **Lang:** This column identifies which language that row's text is in.
- **Target:** This is the expression or phrase of interest as it appears in the English text, which you will use to pinpoint the equivalent expression or phrase in the Mandarin/German/Japanese text. Don't worry if what occurs in the non-English isn't 100% equivalent to the Target, such as presence or absence of a passive (e.g., *the words had been spoken (by him)* versus *he spoke the words*); the Target is there as a guide, rather than a strict reference for equivalence.
- **Text:** This is the text that you will evaluate. Each sheet has paired alternating lines of text in English and a second language so that you can also reference the full English text if needed (e.g., if the context of the Target is particularly impactful, etc.).
- **Gram:** This is where you will identify the way(s) in which each PLG is expressed.

- **Metadata:** The metadata column is used for internal notes between annotators (see below for more).

2.2 Workflow

Once you’ve identified the relevant Target phrase in Mandarin/German/Japanese, use the dropdown box in the Gram column to annotate how that phrase is expressed. (I apologize for the weirdness where there’s a dropdown in both the English and M/G/J rows, there wasn’t a simple way to fix it; only the non-English row needs to be filled in.) The box will let you make multiple selections, and please be sure to mark all elements that appear in the target phrase, and only elements that appear in the target phrase.

For example, an English target phrase “I **have never disobeyed** your orders” might be expressed in Mandarin as *cónglái méiyǒu wéibèi guò nǐ de mìnglìng*, in which case you would select both “meiyou” and “guo” from the dropdown menu. Similarly, an English target phrase “For if the mighty works **had been done** in Tyre and Sidon” might be expressed in German as *denn wenn in Tyrus und Sidon die Machtvollen **taten geschehen wären***, in which case you would select “k2” and “prat” because *wären* is the Konjunktiv II Präteritum of the auxiliary verb *sein*, and also “partizip” because the verb *geschehen* here is expressed as a participle (also *geschehen*).

The list of gram components that are currently provided in the dropdowns is pulled directly from what appeared in the pilot study, but it’s quite possible that additional components will come up in your annotations. If/when you encounter something that isn’t already in the list, please feel free to add it manually. To do so, navigate to the workbook tab labeled “Ref” (for “reference”), where you will see a list of components by language. The functionality is set up so that up to 50 items can be added per language, and once you type it in it will appear automatically in the dropdown menu. In terms of how what to call it, anything specific and descriptive works.

Currently the dropdown menu items have some rough color coding; I’m a very visual person so I added it in, but if it’s distracting or there is a system that makes more sense to you, please let me know and I’m happy to make changes.

2.3 Special Cases

Sometimes the target phrase in English and the corresponding phrase in Mandarin/German/Japanese don’t quite align perfectly. This is fine! There are broadly two types of cases where this happens: when the phrases are roughly equivalent and when they are not. I’ll do my best to describe them clearly here but to some extent it’s always a bit subjective, so feel free to use your best judgment, I trust you!

Roughly equivalent phrases. Sometimes the English and non-English target phrases express essentially the same thing, such as a past event of saying or eating or hearing, etc., or perhaps an ongoing event (e.g., “we have been coming here for years”), but there’s a special nuance to either the English or the non-English that isn’t present in the other. For example, in some languages the form of the verb that’s used for such a phrase still expresses the same type of event but also indicates how the speaker/writer knows about the event (e.g., by witnessing it first hand versus by hearing it from someone else), in which case there’s an extra element of meaning in the non-English that’s absent in the English. When this happens in the Mandarin/German/Japanese, please use the **metadata column** to make note of the special meaning difference. Don’t worry about using technical vocabulary or anything like that, as long as it’s clear enough for me to interpret that works great¹.

¹For example, in a language that specifies how a speaker knows something, I wouldn’t expect you put “epistemic

Non-equivalent or missing phrases. Sometimes the meaning of English target phrase is expressed completely differently in another language, or the phrase may be missing altogether. Some examples are given below:

- (2) a. English: “they **have** already **been paid** in full”
b. German: “sie haben Ihren Lohn dahin” (‘they have their full wages’)

- (3) a. English: “When finds it he will be filled with more joy than he **would have** if he had stayed with the ninety-nine”
b. Mandarin: “tā ruò zhǎodàole, jiù wèi zhè yī zhī yáng huānxǐ, shèngguò wèi nà jiǔshíjiǔ zhǐ méiyǒu míshī de” (‘if he finds it, he rejoices over that one sheep more than over the ninety-nine that were not lost.’)

- (4) Target phrase missing
a. English: “they were perplexed about what **had happened**”
b. German: “sie darüber ratlos waren” (‘they were perplexed about it’)
c. Mandarin: “tāmen zhèng wèi cǐ shì cāiyí de shíhòu” (‘when they were suspicious about this’)

In (2) the English target phrase *have been paid* is implicit in the German, but no actual event of paying takes place. Similarly, in (3) the English target phrase *would have been [filled with joy]* is expressed instead as “he rejoices”, with no event of being/becoming filled with joy specifically mentioned. Both the German and the Mandarin in (4) are examples of a case where the verb and its meaning are absent altogether; the English target phrase (*about what*) *had happened* is omitted and expressed simply as “about it/this”. In these cases, where the substance of the English target phrase isn’t included in the non-English text, please apply the label “n_a” in the Gram column.

Again, often these cases are borderline, so please feel free to use your best judgment. That said, I’m always happy to talk them over with you if one is particularly sticky, reach out to me anytime!

modality” or “evidentiality”, but rather just “means he heard it from someone else” or similar is fine.